The Morning Dispatch

VOL. I · NO. 2 THURSDAY, NOVEMBER 5, 2026 STANDARD EDITION · TOKYO

NASDAQ COMP.	S&P 500	ACWI ETF	NIKKEI 225
25,736.51	**7,688.62**	**$158.48**	**62,188**
▲ +1.44%	▲ +1.58%	change n/a	▼ −1.42%
USD/JPY	**GBP/JPY**	**WTI CRUDE**	**GOLD (SPOT)**
≈158.25	**≈213.5**	**$87.13**	**≈$4,130**
yen ▲ +0.08%	▲ ≈+0.2% 2-month high	▼ −1.12%	▲ ≈+1.7%

DOW 53,356.12 ▲ 3.03% TOPIX ≈3,895 ▼ 0.89% BRENT $93.63 ▼ 1.05% DOLLAR INDEX 101.41 ▼ 0.06%

TODAY Mississippi resumes counting Senate ballots · **21:00 JST — Bank of England rate decision (hike to 4% expected)**

AHEAD **Fri 6 — U.S. October jobs report** · Mon 9 — COP31 climate summit opens in Antalya · Nov 10, 13, 18 — Alaska count updates (**18th: ranked-choice tally**) · Dec — next Bank of Japan hike expected

TOP STORY

Democrats Win Congress in Stinging Rebuke of Trump

★★★☆ **C1** **POLITICS · FULL REPORT, PAGE 2**

Democrats have won control of both the House and the Senate in Tuesday's midterm elections, according to the Associated Press and every major U.S. television network. Voters angry about high prices and the war with Iran handed the opposition a **sweeping** victory. Democrats hold about 54 Senate seats and lead 240 to 147 in the House; two Senate races remain too close to call.

Why it matters: Democrats can now block President Trump's bills and investigate his government, but he keeps his veto.

POLITICS & WORLD · p.2–3 Congress flips · Iran deal · Tokyo	**MARKETS · p.4–5** Dow +1,569 · pound/yen · movers	**SCIENCE & TECH · p.5–6** Brain data · Binance · Swift
SOCIETY & SPORTS · p.6 Como 9–1 · Seoul · Chicago	**DEEP DIVE · p.7–8** The data-center backlash	**TODAY'S WORDS · p.9** 28 key words, with meanings

The Weight of 1,138 Votes

THE DAY'S COLUMN · ★★★☆ C1

We live in an age of instant answers. A score appears before the whistle blows. Yet democracy still moves at the speed of paper.

This morning, a Senate seat in Mississippi depends on 1,138 votes, about one in every 800 ballots cast for the two leading candidates. In Alaska the gap is 637. Somewhere in those states, officials are opening envelopes, checking signatures and counting again.

It is easy to call this slow. It is more accurate to call it careful: each vote belongs to a person who trusted it would be counted, and the wait is the price of that promise. A thin **margin** will disappoint one side whoever wins, but the machinery of counting deserves our patience as much as our **scrutiny**.

The markets will move in milliseconds today. The count in Mississippi will move in envelopes. Both will give us an answer. Only one asks us to wait for it.

Stocks: Nov 4 closes. FX, oil, gold: Nov 5 morning. ≈ approximate. ACWI = iShares ETF; daily change unavailable. **Difficulty (CEFR, editor's estimate):** ★ = A1–B1 · ★★ = B2 · ★★★ = C1 · ★★★★ = C2. **Blue underlined bold** words are explained on page 9.

Democrats Win Both Houses of Congress in Stinging Rebuke of Trump

★★★☆ **C1** **U.S. MIDTERM ELECTIONS**

WASHINGTON — Democrats won control of the House of Representatives and the Senate in Tuesday's midterm elections, according to projections by the Associated Press and every major U.S. television network. It is a major setback for President Donald Trump, with two years left in his term.

The House was called first, just before 10 p.m. Eastern time, and the Senate about ninety minutes later. By early Thursday the AP counted 240 Democratic House seats to 147 Republican, with 48 races still open. Networks project a final Democratic total of roughly 250 to 268, which NBC says would be the largest House majority in nearly two decades.

In the Senate, Democrats needed a net gain of four seats and have so far picked up seven. In Texas, James Talarico defeated Ken Paxton, the first Democratic Senate win there in 38 years, according to CNN. Troy Jackson **unseated** Susan Collins in Maine, 53 percent to 47, and Sherrod Brown beat Jon Husted in Ohio. Democrats also flipped the governorships of Georgia and Texas.

Exit polls pointed to the cost of living and the war with Iran, which began on Feb. 28 and pushed fuel prices to records. Early exit polls put the president's approval at 38 percent. Hakeem Jeffries, running for Speaker, promised quick votes to restore health-insurance subsidies and end the tariffs; Speaker Mike Johnson said Republicans "will not be deterred by the outcome of one election." Mr. Trump keeps his veto, and Senate Republicans keep the **filibuster**.

Sources: AP/PBS · Variety · CBS · CNN · ABC

BALANCE OF POWER (PROJECTIONS)

	Dem.	Rep.	Open
Senate (51 needed)	**54***	**44**	**2**
House (218 needed)	**240**	**147**	**48**

*Includes allied independents (ABC/CBS tally). House: AP count, early Thursday ET. Not certified results.

TOO CLOSE TO CALL

Mississippi: Colom (D) 464,926, Hyde-Smith (R) 463,788 — a 1,138-vote gap with about 96% counted. The lead has changed hands. There is no formal **recount**; only a court-ordered review is possible.
Alaska: Peltola (D) leads Sullivan (R) by about 637 votes. Ranked-choice transfers on Nov. 18 may favor Sullivan.

HOW THE MEDIA FRAMED IT (FACTS FIRST, THEN VIEWS)

AP Called it a "shockingly decisive rebuke" of Mr. Trump; voters cited high prices, the Iran war and corruption concerns.

CNN · MS NOW CNN commentator Van Jones: "the repudiation of Trumpism." MS NOW host Rachel Maddow: "a seismic change in Washington."

FOX NEWS Headlines spoke of a "historic blue wave" and the "GOP's midterm massacre," stressing that the Republican affordability message fell flat.

ABROAD Libération: "une vague bleue." Daily Mail: "historic blue tsunami." Kyiv Independent: a "potential boost for Ukraine." Rossiyskaya Gazeta: Trump's wrath "will fall on Europe."

Views are drawn from published headlines and reported statements. NPR/OPB · Fox News · MS NOW

Allies Cautiously Hopeful, Beijing Neutral, Tehran Defiant

★★☆☆ **B2** **WORLD REACTION**

Berlin: Chancellor Friedrich Merz doubted much would change: "Why should things be any different now?" he asked. **Brussels:** an EU Parliament vice president is "cautiously optimistic," but says Europe must stand on its own.

Beijing: The foreign ministry called it a "domestic affair."

Tehran: Supreme Leader Mojtaba Khamenei said a change of party would not end U.S. hostility.

Al Jazeera · Axios · NPR

Oil Falls as Vance Blames Iran War for Defeat; Qatar Floats a Deal

Brent drops to a two-month low, but tankers are still being hit near the Strait of Hormuz.

★★★☆ **C1** **ENERGY & THE GULF**

Vice President JD Vance wrote on X that the war with Iran was why Republicans lost. Mr. Trump called that "largely true," but said he had no regrets and told the Financial Times he had no immediate plans to strike Iran. Traders took it as a sign the war may be winding down. Brent crude fell about 8 percent on Wednesday and traded near $93.6 on Thursday, a two-month low and roughly a fifth below last week's peak of $116–118. U.S. crude settled at $88.12.

Qatari mediators are seeking American and Iranian backing for a draft agreement that could restart direct talks within days, through three days of confidence-building steps. Tehran demands an end to the U.S. naval **blockade**, sanctions relief and the release of frozen funds before it reopens the Strait of Hormuz. Neither government has confirmed the draft, so it should be read as a possibility, not a deal.

The danger has not passed. Iran's Revolutionary Guards said two tankers and a tugboat caught fire in the strait, and one tanker hit a mine. Another tanker was struck by two projectiles north of Qatar, according to the UKMTO. In Washington, CBS reports Mr. Trump has asked aides whether Defense Secretary Pete Hegseth should stay; the White House says he has "full confidence" in him.

HOW DIFFERENT OUTLETS FRAMED IT

AXIOS · CNBC · FT Treat the new Congress as a new constraint on the war.

IRAN'S GHALIBAF The Parliament Speaker, Iran's chief negotiator, wrote: "Americans said NO TO WAR, and we endorse this message."

GULF NEWS Stresses that Mr. Trump is torn between renewed strikes and a deal.

Axios · CNBC · Gulf News · Oilprice.com

Tokyo Calls the U.S. Alliance Its 'Cornerstone' as Officials Fear 'Legacy Deals'

Japan stresses continuity after the U.S. vote, while worrying privately that a weakened president may court Beijing and Pyongyang.

★★★☆ **C1** **JAPAN · ALSO: TAKAICHI WILL SKIP THE COP31 LEADERS' SUMMIT (THIRD YEAR RUNNING)**

TOKYO — The Japan–U.S. alliance is the **cornerstone** of Japan's foreign and security policy whatever the election result, Chief Cabinet Secretary Minoru Kihara said on Wednesday. He pledged to work with Washington "at all levels, including between our leaders and foreign ministers," and said the government would watch markets "with a high sense of urgency."

In private, officials are more uneasy. According to Jiji Press, they fear a weakened Mr. Trump may court China, North Korea and Russia in search of legacy wins, a particular risk for Tokyo over Taiwan and North Korea's abductions of Japanese citizens. Prime Minister Sanae Takaichi wants to meet him soon.

At home, Ms. Takaichi remains popular. A JNN poll taken Oct. 31 to Nov. 1 put cabinet approval at 64.9 percent, according to the Japan Times, despite high living costs and strained ties with China.

TWO READINGS OF THE SAME WEEK

GOVERNMENT LINE Continuity: the alliance is the cornerstone, and leaders will talk soon.

JIJI PRESS (OFFICIALS, PRIVATELY) Worry that a president seeking a legacy may make deals with rivals over Japan's head.

Kyodo/Anadolu · Jiji/Nippon.com · Japan Times · Japan Times (COP31)

Dow Jumps 1,569 Points on ‘Election Clarity,’ but AI Stocks Fall

Investors cheer divided government and cheaper oil, but fret over possible curbs on data centers.

★★★☆ **C1** **WALL STREET · NOV 4 SESSION**

NEW YORK — The Dow Jones Industrial Average jumped 1,569.40 points, or 3.03 percent, to 53,356.12 on Wednesday, its best day since April 2025. The S&P 500 rose 1.58 percent to 7,688.62, and the Nasdaq Composite gained 1.44 percent to 25,736.51. CNN called it the Dow's best post-midterm day in 44 years.

Investors read **gridlock** in Washington as a brake on big spending, and the sharp fall in oil eased inflation fears. Amazon, Microsoft and Apple led the rally, and solar shares rose on bets that clean-energy support will survive. Defense stocks such as Northrop Grumman, RTX and Lockheed Martin fell, because Mr. Trump's $1.5 trillion defense budget request now faces a tougher Congress.

The builders of artificial-intelligence infrastructure did not join the party. Nvidia fell 3 percent, and an ETF tracking AI-infrastructure stocks lost 9 percent, according to CNN. Several newly elected Democratic governors campaigned on restricting data centers (see our Deep Dive, page 7). The dollar index slipped to 101.41 in Asian trade on Thursday.

HOW THE COVERAGE DIFFERED

CBS · ABC · CNBC Framed it as a relief rally after an uncertain campaign.

REUTERS (TOKYO) · JAPAN TIMES Led with the AI and chip sell-off, because Tokyo's market is heavy in chip stocks.

DAN IVES, WEDBUSH Democratic control “will create some major hurdles for AI and tech legislation.”

AIDAN YAO, AMUNDI Told Reuters the vote looked “more like a **referendum** on AI than a referendum on Trump.”

ABC · CBS · CNN/WTTW · StockTitan · Reuters

Pound Hits Two-Month High Against Yen as Bank of England Decision Nears

★★★☆ **C1** **CURRENCIES · GBP/JPY**

Sterling climbed to a two-month high against the yen on Wednesday, trading just below 213.50, up about 0.2 percent after a rebound from around 212.00. The main reason is today's Bank of England decision at noon in London (21:00 JST). Markets have almost fully **priced in** a quarter-point **hike** in Bank Rate to 4 percent from 3.75 percent. Economists polled by Reuters expect a 7–2 vote, the first increase since August 2023, after UK inflation rose to 3.5 percent in September from 3.1 percent in August.

The yen is the weaker side of the pair. The timing of the Bank of Japan's next rate rise is uncertain, although minutes of its September meeting, when it lifted rates to 1.25 percent, strengthened bets on a December move. Finance Minister Satsuki Katayama has warned that Tokyo will act against “disorderly” currency moves, which limits how far the yen can fall.

What to watch tonight: the size of the majority and what the Bank says about further increases. This is information, not investment advice.

Tradingpedia · Bloomberg · Reuters FX

GBP/JPY AT A GLANCE

Level	**≈213.5**
Wednesday low	**≈212.0**
BoE Bank Rate now	**3.75%**
Expected today	**4.00%**
UK CPI (Sept)	**3.5%**
BOJ policy rate	**1.25%**

OIL, GOLD, ASIA

Brent near $93.6 (≈ −8% Wed.); WTI $87.13. Gold ≈ $4,130 after +2.6% Wed. Nikkei 62,188 (−1.42%), TOPIX −0.89%.

MARKETS & ECONOMY (CONTINUED)

Stocks of the Day: A Craft-Machine Maker Surges, Trump Media Sinks

★★☆☆ **B2** **BIGGEST MOVERS · REGULAR SESSION, NOV 4**

Cricut, the maker of craft cutting machines, rose 48.74 percent after third-quarter revenue grew 11 percent to $188.6 million and it declared a 70-cent special dividend. Lyell Immunopharma jumped 43 percent on lymphoma trial results.

On the way down, Trump Media, owner of Truth Social, fell 24.54 percent after the Democrats' win, according to CNBC. Amdocs lost 30 percent after forecasting lower fiscal 2027 revenue, and FIS fell 23.67 percent after cutting its 2026 earnings-growth forecast. In Tokyo, Kioxia fell 10 percent in morning trade.

StockTitan/CNBC · Reuters via The Star · from a Nov 4 market wrap; not a full screen of all stocks.

Stock	Move
Cricut	▲ +48.7%
Lyell Immunopharma	▲ +43.3%
Amdocs	▼ −30.1%
Trump Media	▼ −24.5%

SCIENCE & TECHNOLOGY

Your Brain Waves May Be Training Someone's AI

★★★☆ **C1** **AI & PRIVACY**

Makers of consumer neurotech headbands have **amassed** tens of millions of hours of brain-wave data to train artificial intelligence, an investigation published Nov. 4 in *Science* reports. Many users do not realize their data is being used this way, and the companies face few legal limits.

Science separately says the midterm results "brighten prospects for science" after two years of cuts.

Science · Scientific American

Binance Resumes Withdrawals After Record $6.3 Billion Hack

★★★☆ **C1** **CRYPTO**

Binance, the world's largest crypto exchange, lost a record $6.3 billion from its hot wallets on Oct. 29, about four times the $1.5 billion Bybit **heist** of 2025. The FBI has linked the attack to North Korea. The exchange has restarted withdrawals in phases and says: "Binance will absorb the financial impact."

CNN · TRM Labs · Yahoo Finance

NASA's Swift Telescope Burns Up After 22 Years

★★☆☆ **B2** **SPACE**

NASA's Swift space **observatory**, which spent more than two decades studying gamma-ray bursts and other cosmic explosions, fell back to Earth and burned up in the atmosphere. A rescue mission earlier this year had failed.

Scientific American

California Has Far More Insects Than Anyone Thought

★★☆☆ **B2** **BIODIVERSITY**

DNA barcoding of over a million **specimens** suggests California has more than 60,000 insect species, and about a third have not yet been described by science.

Phys.org

SCIENCE IN BRIEF

Two Million Eels on One Underwater Mountain

★☆☆☆ **B1** **OCEANS**

Scientists have counted over two million basketwork eels on a single **seamount**, an underwater mountain. Patience Seamount, off Tasmania, hosts the gathering every year. Nobody yet knows why.

Phys.org · Scientific American

Supersonic Waves and Strange Planet Orbits

★★★☆ **C1** **ASTRONOMY**

Simulations suggest supersonic waves may help giant gas planets, such as "hot Jupiters," move into very close **orbits** around their stars.

Inca Children Were Given Drugs, Tests Show

★★★☆ **C1** **ARCHAEOLOGY**

New **toxicology** tests show Inca children were given cocaine, alcohol and ayahuasca compounds before being sacrificed (Scientific American, Nov. 3).

SPORTS

Champions League: Como Win 9–1; Liverpool Stunned in Istanbul

★★☆☆ **B2** **FOOTBALL · MATCHDAY 4, NOV 4**

Como beat Lens 9–1, matching the Champions League record winning margin of eight goals; Tasos Douvikas scored a hat-trick. Real Madrid stayed **unbeaten** by beating AEK Athens 3–2 after Federico Valverde's winner in added time, having come from behind twice.

Fenerbahçe beat Liverpool 3–2 on Vedat Muriqi's 79th-minute header, their first Champions League win since 2008, ending Liverpool's perfect record in the league phase. Erling Haaland scored late to give Manchester City a 3–2 win at Leipzig, and Arsenal won 2–1 at Slavia Prague to stay third. Paris Saint-Germain and Real Madrid lead with 12 points each, ahead of Arsenal on 10; Como, Barcelona, Aston Villa, Manchester City and Liverpool are on nine.

UEFA · The Sports Encounter

Results, Nov 4

Lens – Como	**1–9**
AEK Athens – Real Madrid	**2–3**
Fenerbahçe – Liverpool	**3–2**
Leipzig – Man City	**2–3**
Slavia Prague – Arsenal	**1–2**
Villarreal – PSG	**0–6**
Barcelona – Aston Villa	**3–0**

CULTURE & SOCIETY NOTES

Theaster Gates Brings 'African Still Lifes' to Seoul

★★☆☆ **B2** **ART**

The American artist's first solo **exhibition** in Korea, at White Cube Seoul in Gangnam, links Black American history with Korean culture. Gates connected Black church gospel music with the Korean singing tradition of pansori, and saw parallels between Korean ceramics and his own visual style.

NewCity · Yahoo News

Joffrey Ballet Announces 'Notes on Love'

★★☆☆ **B2** **DANCE**

Chicago's Joffrey Ballet will stage ten performances at the Lyric Opera House, Feb. 4–14. The mixed program opens with the world **premiere** of "Dear Chicago: A Love Letter" by Houston Thomas, with an original score by Jonathan Bingham, plus works by Liam Scarlett and Nicolas Blanc.

Offbeat: Ballots in Orange Bags

★☆☆☆ **B1** **SOCIETY**

When the **scanners** failed across Westchester County, New York, on Election Day, poll workers stuffed paper ballots into orange bags to count by hand.

The Data-Center Backlash: How AI's Hunger for Power Became a Campaign Issue

Markets sold AI infrastructure after the midterms. The cause is not only Washington politics: from New York to Texas, voters are asking who pays for the electricity.

★★★☆ **C1** **DEEP DIVE · POLITICS, ENERGY, MARKETS**

−9% AI-infrastructure ETF, Wednesday (CNN)	**≈45%** Planned U.S. data-center capacity "at risk" (Goldman Sachs estimate)	**12 GW** Projects waiting for grid links in New York	**15 of 36** Governor races with pause-backing candidates (pre-election analysis)

The market message. When the results came in, the clearest losers on Wall Street were the companies that build the machinery of artificial intelligence. An exchange-traded fund tracking AI-infrastructure stocks fell 9 percent on Wednesday and Nvidia fell 3 percent, while the Dow rose more than 3 percent. Analysts kept giving the same reason: fear of tighter rules on data centers. Goldman Sachs warned that Democratic statehouse wins could put roughly 45 percent of planned U.S. data-center capacity at risk, and a CNBC voter poll found 56 percent of voters called data centers a crucial or major factor.

Why voters care. The complaint is usually less about AI than about the household bill: data centers use huge amounts of electricity, and opponents argue that ordinary customers end up paying for the power plants and power lines built to serve them. Residential electricity prices were forecast to rise about 4 percent in 2026, after roughly 5 percent in 2025, according to CNBC. Higher utility bills were also a key factor in Democrat Abigail Spanberger's landslide win in Virginia's 2025 governor's race.

It is not only a Democratic cause. Bernie Sanders has called for a national **moratorium**, but Florida's Republican governor, Ron DeSantis, backs an "AI bill of rights" letting communities block data centers. In Michigan, both leading candidates for governor backed a pause: Democrat Jocelyn Benson proposed one year, and Republican John James proposed a halt until there is "a plan to protect the communities." In Ohio, Republican Vivek Ramaswamy pledged to halt new approvals by executive order, while Democrat Amy Acton backed a conditional moratorium. In Texas, Gov. Greg Abbott announced a temporary pause, which Democrat Gina Hinojosa called "a scam" and said should be an immediate halt. Ms. Hinojosa, Ms. Acton and Georgia's Keisha Lance Bottoms, who wants construction stopped, were all elected on Tuesday, according to Fortune.

TIMELINE: FROM LOCAL FIGHT TO STATEWIDE POLICY

Nov 2025	Virginia governor's race: utility bills cited as a key factor in Democrat Abigail Spanberger's landslide win.
Jan 2026	Sen. Sanders and Florida's Republican Gov. DeSantis both criticize the AI data-center boom.
Mar 25	Sanders and Rep. Alexandria Ocasio-Cortez propose a nationwide freeze on new AI data centers. The Trump administration rejects it.
Apr	Maine's legislature approves an 18-month pause on facilities above 20 MW; Gov. Janet Mills vetoes it after lawmakers decline to exempt a redevelopment project in Jay.
Jul 14	New York Gov. Kathy Hochul orders the first statewide moratorium on new hyperscale projects above 50 MW, while the state studies grid, water, air and climate effects.
Jul–Nov	Candidates in up to 15 of 36 governor races back a pause (*The Information*, Nov. 1). Fourteen state legislatures have introduced restrictive bills. Voters decide on Nov. 3.

Sources: Data Center Watch · AI Weekly · BD+C · Verified · Fortune · CNN. Goldman and CNBC-poll figures as reported Nov. 4; originals not opened.

Deep Dive · continued on page 8

THE ARGUMENTS, SIDE BY SIDE

For a pause	Against a pause
Sanders and Ocasio-Cortez: data-center growth burdens communities and makes residents subsidize Big Tech's energy use; a freeze should last until laws ensure new centers do not raise consumer electricity rates or worsen climate change.	**White House AI adviser David Sacks:** a national freeze would let China win the AI race. Interior Secretary Doug Burgum and Sen. John Fetterman, a Democrat, called a pause a "surrender flag" to Beijing.
Gov. Hochul: pause large projects while the state studies grid, water, air and climate effects; make developers help fund grid upgrades and reconsider tax incentives.	**The administration** prefers market solutions, such as a voluntary "Ratepayer Protection Pledge" in which big tech firms absorb more of their energy costs. Georgia's Republican Gov. Brian Kemp warned that Ms. Bottoms's approach means "moratoriums on growth."

Positions as reported by Verified, Stateline, Data Center Watch and the Washington Examiner. Our summaries of both sides are meant to be fair; read the originals for full arguments.

WHAT THIS MEANS FOR MARKETS

Wednesday's 9 percent fall in one AI-infrastructure fund prices a fear, not a law. Goldman's 45 percent is an estimate of capacity *at risk*, not capacity cancelled. So far only one state, New York, has an order in force, and most restrictions have come from counties and towns. The federal bill, which faced long odds in the old Congress, still needs Mr. Trump's signature, and he keeps his veto.

The risk for investors is therefore less a single national ban than a patchwork: different rules, delays and costs from state to state. Japan's market is exposed because chip and memory makers such as Kioxia, Advantest and Tokyo Electron sell into the AI build-out. GCI Asset Management's Takamasa Ikeda said the Democratic wins "fuelled caution for stricter regulations on AI infrastructure investment."

The Data Center Watch newsletter adds a caution of its own: candidates in several states have linked election losses to controversial data-center projects, but whether those projects were decisive is unclear.

WHERE THE PAUSES STAND

Federal	Proposed (Mar). White House opposed. Not law.
New York	In force by executive order; projects above 50 MW.
Maine	Passed legislature; vetoed.
Texas	Temporary pause announced; challenger called it "a scam."
Local	100+ communities have moratoriums (as of March).
States	14 legislatures have introduced bills.

EDITOR'S ASSESSMENT — WHAT THE EVIDENCE SUPPORTS, AND WHAT IT DOES NOT

1. The driver is the power bill. The common thread across parties is electricity prices and grid strain, not hostility to AI itself. That is why Republicans and Democrats alike have proposed pauses.

2. Cost-sharing looks likelier than bans. The measures that have actually passed or been proposed mix pauses with rules on who pays: New York wants developers to fund grid upgrades, Maine ended tax breaks, and the administration offers a voluntary pledge. In my reading, the most probable near-term result is rules about who pays, not a blanket freeze. This is a judgment, not a certainty.

3. The vote may be a trigger, not the cause. The election gave investors a concrete political risk to price. Whether the fear lasts depends on what new governors actually sign.

4. Things to watch: the first executive orders from newly elected governors; the results of New York's study; utility rate cases; whether a divided government takes up ratepayer protections; and how the biggest AI companies describe their spending plans. This is analysis, not investment advice.

TODAY'S WORDS — 28 KEY WORDS FROM THIS ISSUE

Levels (CEFR) are the editor's estimates. The words are bold, blue and underlined in the articles.

sweeping	B2	広範囲の、圧倒的な *a sweeping victory*
margin	B2	差、余白 *a thin margin*
scrutiny	C1	厳しい検査、監視 *deserves our scrutiny*
unseat	C1	（現職を）落選させる *Jackson unseated Collins.*
filibuster	C2	議事妨害 *Republicans keep the filibuster.*
recount	C1	再集計 *There is no formal recount.*
defiant	C1	反抗的な、強気の *Tehran remains defiant.*
blockade	C1	封鎖 *the U.S. naval blockade*
gridlock	C1	行き詰まり、膠着 *gridlock in Washington*
referendum	C1	国民投票、信任投票 *a referendum on AI*
hike	B2	（金利の）引き上げ *a quarter-point hike*
priced in	C1	（相場に）織り込み済み *almost fully priced in*
surge	B2	急騰する、急増 *Cricut surged 49 percent.*
amass	C2	大量に蓄積する *amassed millions of hours*
heist	C2	大がかりな盗み *a record crypto heist*
observatory	C1	観測所、天文台 *the Swift observatory*
specimen	C1	標本、見本 *a million specimens*
seamount	C2	海山（海底の山） *Patience Seamount*
orbit	B2	軌道 *very close orbits*
toxicology	C2	毒物学 *toxicology tests*
cornerstone	C1	礎、基軸 *the cornerstone of policy*
unbeaten	B2	無敗の *Real Madrid stayed unbeaten.*
exhibition	B1	展覧会 *a solo exhibition*
premiere	B2	初演、初公開 *a world premiere*
scanner	B2	読み取り機 *The scanners failed.*
backlash	C1	強い反発 *the data-center backlash*
moratorium	C2	一時停止、凍結 *a statewide moratorium*
ratepayer	C2	（電気料金などの）利用者 *Ratepayer Protection Pledge*

ABOUT THIS EDITION

Compiled by Claude from reporting by AP, Reuters, CNN, CBS, NBC, ABC, Fox News, MS NOW, CNBC, Axios, Al Jazeera, NPR, UEFA, Gulf News, Jiji Press, Kyodo, The Japan Times, Bloomberg, *Science*, Scientific American, Phys.org and others. Stories are rewritten summaries; click or tap a source name to read the original. Election results are media projections, not certified counts, and seat totals differ slightly between outlets. Outlet views come from published headlines and reported statements, not from full articles behind paywalls. Market figures are from the sources named, at the times stated; the ACWI daily change and the CNBC poll and Goldman estimate could not be confirmed from the original pages. CEFR levels are estimates. Nothing here is investment advice.